

A

Agreeing

Carla's meeting (see previous unit) continues.

The phrases in bold can be used when agreeing with people.

You may be right there. The budget figures are not looking good. But on the other hand we mustn't forget the other benefits for the company.



You can also say:

- a **I couldn't agree more.** We got our latest recruits after we won the Advertising Industry Award for best advertisement last year.
- b **Precisely.** Creativity comes to some of our people in the middle of the night.
- c **Exactly.** It's the creative people who bring in all the money.
- d **Absolutely.** It's the output that counts.



You're perfectly right. We are the people who are the driving force behind the company.

You can also say:

- e **That's true, I suppose.** But we must think of the company as a whole.
- f **I suppose so.** But other employees mustn't be forgotten.

B

Disagreeing

That's not really how I see it. Designers and accounts people are all company employees.



You can also say:

- g **I don't really agree.** The prizes that the designers get are important, but people would come to work for us anyway.
- h **I can't go along with you there.** I think we need to see people at their desks actually working.
- i **I think you're mistaken.** If the designers get to work late, they should be disciplined.
- j **I'm afraid I can't agree with you there.** We all depend on each other for the company to make money.
- k **I'm sorry, but that's out of the question.** All employees should keep to normal working hours.



I think you're wrong. The design department's costs are justified because of our high-quality work. The costs of the other departments are not justified.

You can also say:

- l **Of course not.** The latest figures I've seen show that the project is within budget.
- m **That's absurd.** You can't expect us to leave at 10 in the evening and be back at 8 in the morning.
- n **That's ridiculous.** Each department has very specific needs.

Note

Be careful with **That's absurd**, **That's ridiculous** and **Of course not**. These expressions are very strong and can be offensive.

Exercises

58.1 Put the expressions in A and B opposite into the following groups:

- | | |
|---------------------|-----------------------|
| 1 mild agreement | 3 strong agreement |
| 2 mild disagreement | 4 strong disagreement |

58.2 The expressions below follow on immediately from those in A opposite. Match the continuations (1–6) with the expressions (a–f).

- | | |
|---|--------------------------|
| 1 We don't care about the hours that each person in our department works. | ☐ |
| 2 Besides that, the prizes help us to attract and keep the best designers. | ☐ |
| 3 Not only do we have these very high costs, but it also sets a very bad example to the other departments and they start going over budget too. | ☐ |
| 4 We're all in this together. | ☐ |
| 5 Without us, there would be no profits. | ☐ |
| 6 You should be looking at what we produce, not at the time of day we produce it. | ☐ |

58.3 Two advertising managers, Georgina and Henry, are exchanging opinions. Use expressions from B opposite (g–n) containing the word in brackets to complete what Henry says. Then match what Georgina says with Henry's replies.

Georgina	Henry
1 The agency should move its offices out of Soho to the suburbs somewhere.	 (absurd). We would lose employees to our competitors if we cut salaries.
2 Times are difficult and everyone should take a 10 per cent pay cut.	 (along). The agency is at its most creative now.
3 The real problem is the number of unproductive people in the agency.	 (ridiculous). We need to stay in the creative heart of London.
4 When they travel on business, everyone should stay at the same low-cost hotels in order to cut costs.	 (afraid). People need to get away from their offices sometimes.
5 One reason for our high costs is employees who go out for coffee in the local bars twice a day.	 (really). Other advertising agencies are doing well, despite the economy.
6 If the agency's less profitable than it was, it's because economic conditions are terrible.	 (course). Everyone in the agency works hard.
7 If we could get back to the creativity we had when the agency was founded, all our problems would be solved.	 (course). Everyone in the agency works hard.
	 (question). Some of the accommodation is really bad.

Over to you

- Is it acceptable for people to disagree openly with each other in your company/country?
- Do you prefer to avoid arguments?